

BEYOND THE CREST

The Smilley Family & Smilley Corporation — Document 06

A Daytime Drama

The secondary family of Beyond the Crest

Smilley Corporation: founded Monday, September 9, 1974, New York City

Home: Tuxedo Park, Buckhead, Atlanta, just across the ridge from Belmont Crest

The Feud in One Page

The Smilleys are the Donohues' fiercest rivals and competitors, and the two families are always at odds. The Donohues are old money that built Black Atlanta. The Smilleys are the family Atlanta threw out, who came back rich enough to buy the block. And the thing the Smilleys hate most: their empire still runs on Donohue oxygen.

- **1958:** Alexander Donohue fires Otis Smiley, the Beacon's press foreman, for stealing printing plates. Otis swears he was framed. His son Gus is 15.
- **1962:** Otis applies to live in Belmont Crest. Simone Donohue casts the deciding vote: no.
- **1963:** Gus leaves for Harlem, vowing to come back richer than the Donohues.
- **1966:** In New York, Gus falls for a Broadway ingenue named Joan Mercer and proposes. She says “not yet,” then goes home and marries Victor Donohue in 1969.
- **1990:** The Crown License makes Smiley dependent on Donohue characters and brands.
- **1996:** Gus moves the company to Atlanta and buys in Tuxedo Park, where he can see Summit House from his terrace.
- **1996:** Gus writes the **Allegiance Clause** into the family charter.
- **2026:** Esther, his chosen heir, has been hiding two Donohue great-granddaughters for fourteen years.

The Allegiance Clause

“No Designated Heir of Smilley International shall be joined by marriage, or bound by blood through their children, to the House of Donohue. Any such heir is disqualified.” Section 4(c), Smilley Family Charter, adopted Monday, June 3, 1996.

That clause is why Esther told the world she used IVF and a sperm donor. If anyone proves that Emma and Victoria are Marc-Anthony Bullock's daughters, Esther loses everything, and Nathaniel and Camille get it.

The Smilley Family

Line	Marriage	Notes
Otis Smilley	1919–1988	Gus's father, fired from the Beacon in 1958 (seen in flashback)
Augustus “Gus” Smilley ∞ Loretta Hayes	m. Saturday, December 21, 1963	Founders
■ Leonard Smilley ∞ Celeste Beaumont	m. Saturday, June 30, 1984	Chairman & CEO / Foundation Chair
■ Nathaniel ∞ Monique Carter	m. 2010	Their son: Trey (b. 2012)
■ Camille ∞ Dorian Ward	m. 2016	No children
■ Esther	Never married	Twins Emma & Victoria (b. 2012; father: Marc-Anthony Bullock, SECRET)
■ Delphine Smilley	Divorced three times	Her son: Desmond (b. 1994)

AUGUSTUS “GUS” SMILLEY

Born: Monday, March 8, 1943 • **Age:** 82

Title: Chairman Emeritus of Smilley Corporation and Chairman of Smilley International

The Founder. Gus is 82 and still sharp: charming, vindictive, and funny. He has spent sixty years trying to prove that Alexander Donohue was wrong about his father. He built a \$1.6 trillion company out of a Harlem pharmacy and a grudge. He still keeps Joan Mercer's 1966 reply letter in his desk.

- Born in Vine City, Atlanta. Watched his father fired in 1958 and the family rejected by Belmont Crest in 1962.
- Moved to Harlem at 20. Married Loretta Hayes in December 1963. Separated from her in 1966 while he chased Joan Mercer, then came home to Loretta for good in 1967.
- Founded Smilley Corporation in 1974 and moved it home to Atlanta in 1996. Wrote the Allegiance Clause the same year.
- Named Esther heir over his son's older children because “she's the only one who's as mean as me.”

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

GUS

The Donohues own the sky over Atlanta. Fine. I own everything people buy while they're looking up at it.

LORETTA SMILLEY

Born: Saturday, July 21, 1945 • **Age:** 80

Title: Co-founder; creator of Loretta's Crown Pomade

The Matriarch. Loretta is the quiet genius: her hair pomade, mixed in a Harlem kitchen in 1971, was Smilley Corporation's first product. She forgave Gus once. She's never forgiven Joan.

- Harlem beautician turned billionaire chemist.
- Knows every secret in the family, including Esther's. She has figured out the twins, and she is saying nothing, for now.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

LORETTA

I built this company with a spoon and a stove,
baby. Don't you dare tell me what I can't cook.

LEONARD SMILLEY

Born: Sunday, October 11, 1964 • **Age:** 61

Title: Chairman & CEO, Smilley Corporation (CEO since 2003; Chairman since 2020)

The Son. Leonard is a brilliant operator in his father's shadow, obsessed with freeing Smilley from Donohue dependence. He secretly funds Pryor's primary challenge to Jasmine.

- Howard University and Harvard Business School.
- Grew Smilley from \$40 billion to \$1.6 trillion, and resents that the Crown License made half of it possible.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

LEONARD

Every dollar we make, Donohue takes a cut. I
want a company that doesn't have to say thank
you.

CELESTE SMILLEY

Born: Tuesday, February 22, 1966 • **Age:** 59

Title: Chair, Smilley Family Foundation; Atlanta society general

The Social General. Celeste is a Beaumont of New Orleans, elegant and ferocious, and she runs Atlanta society's calendar. She adores her grandchildren and her daughter Esther, in that order.

- Beaumont family, New Orleans. Spelman class of 1987.
- Her lifelong rival is Joan Donohue. Their charity galas are held on the same night every year.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

CELESTE

Joan Donohue has a Foundation. I have a guest
list. Guess which one people actually want to be
on.

DELPHINE SMILLEY

Born: Thursday, May 2, 1968 • **Age:** 57

Title: President, Smilley Home

The Truth-Teller. Delphine is Gus's daughter, three times divorced and never boring, and the one Smilley who says what everyone thinks. She's the family's wild card and Desmond's fiercest defender.

- Runs the Smilley Home division: furniture, bedding, and home fragrance.
- Secretly friends with Alvin Donohue since a 1999 night in Monaco nobody talks about.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

DELPHINE

This family has more skeletons than closets, and I'm the only one who ever opens a door.

NATHANIEL SMILLEY

Born: Thursday, March 14, 1985 • **Age:** 40

Title: EVP; President, Smilley Consumer & Digital (includes RootsKit)

The Eldest Son Who Was Passed Over. Nathaniel is 40, polished, cold, and patient. He was raised to be heir and lost the title to his little sister. His RootsKit DNA division becomes the weapon that exposes her.

- Morehouse and Stanford MBA. Launched RootsKit in 2017.
- Forms the “Spare Alliance” with Martin Olson (Ep #0058).
- Secretly finances Harmony's film to get close to Esther.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

NATHANIEL

My sister didn't win. Grandfather just hadn't met the real me yet.

MONIQUE SMILLEY

Born: Wednesday, September 30, 1987 • **Age:** 38

Title: Nathaniel's wife; former Donohue Records singer

Monique was a Donohue Records R&B star until Alvin Donohue dropped her from the label in 2009. She married a Smilley and never forgot it.

- Mother of Trey.
- Wants revenge on Alvin the day he comes home (Season 1, second half).

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

MONIQUE

Alvin Donohue ended my career over a bar tab. I married up just to watch him fall down.

LEONARD “TREY” SMILLEY III

Born: Sunday, January 22, 2012 • **Age:** 13

Title: 8th grader, Westbrook Academy

Trey is the Smilley heir's heir's son: charming, cocky, and quick. He is Lyric Baker's first crush. Romeo, meet Juliet.

- Classmate of the twins and Lyric.
- Kisses Lyric on the first day of 9th grade (Ep #0149), and Victoria punches him.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

TREY

My grandpa says never trust a Donohue. Lyric's
not a Donohue. Technically.

CAMILLE SMILLEY-WARD

Born: Wednesday, November 2, 1988 • **Age:** 37

Title: Chief Financial Officer, Smilley Corporation

The Middle Child. Camille is a numbers assassin. She's loyal to Nathaniel, jealous of Esther, and willing to frame her own cousin to win.

- Wharton. Became CFO at 34.
- Frames Desmond for stealing HEIRLOOM's formulas (Ep #0069) and launches the copycat line (Ep #0106).

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

CAMILLE

Numbers don't lie. People do. That's why I
prefer numbers.

DORIAN WARD

Born: Saturday, July 9, 1983 • **Age:** 42

Title: Chief Strategy Officer, Smilley Corporation

Dorian is Camille's husband. Natasha Donohue fired him from The Donohue Company in 2019, and he's Martin's back channel inside Smilley.

- Knows Donohue Consumer Licensing's playbook by heart.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

DORIAN

I didn't leave Donohue. Donohue left me. I just
took the playbook with me.

DESMOND SMILLEY

Born: Monday, December 12, 1994 • **Age:** 31

Title: Creative Director, Smilley Beauty (resigns in Ep #0114)

Desmond is Delphine's son, a gentle and brilliant artist who falls for Mallory Olson. The Montague who loves a Capulet.

- Framed by Camille, then clears his name.
- Tells Mallory he'll wait for her, as long as it takes.

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

DESMOND

I don't care whose granddaughter you are. I care who you are.

Also Smilleys

Esther, Emma, and Victoria Smilley are fully profiled in Document 02. Esther is President & COO of Smilley Corporation and designated heir of Smilley International. She oversees Smilley Retail, Smilley Beauty, and every Donohue license negotiation.

History of Smilley Corporation

Field	Detail
Legal name	Smilley Corporation (NYSE: SMLY)
Controlling shareholder	Smilley International Holdings, Ltd. (private family holding company)
Industry	Multinational consumer products, retail & lifestyle conglomerate
Founded	Monday, September 9, 1974, Harlem, New York City
Headquarters	Smilley Plaza, 3400 Peachtree Road NE, Buckhead, Atlanta (since 1996)
Market capitalization	\$1.6 trillion
Revenue (FY2025)	\$640 billion
Employees	880,000
Dependence on Donohue	~41% of revenue is tied to the Crown License: Donohue characters, films, and brands on Smilley products, plus ad inventory on Donohue networks

1971–1984: Harlem

- 1971: Loretta mixes the first batch of **Loretta's Crown Pomade** on her stove on West 137th Street. Gus sells it out of a pharmacy on Lenox Avenue.
- Monday, September 9, 1974: Smilley Corporation is incorporated with \$3,800 and one product.
- 1978–1984: Expands into cosmetics, skin care, and household goods. The Black press starts calling Gus “the Black Procter.”

1985–1995: The Big Time

- 1985: IPO on the NYSE, with dual-class shares that keep control in the family.
- 1987: Opens the first **Smilley's** department store on 125th Street.
- 1990: Signs the first **Crown License** with The Donohue Company, putting Donohue characters on Smilley toys, clothes, and school supplies. Revenue triples in five years. Gus calls it “the best deal I ever hated.”

1996–2010: Coming Home

- 1996: Moves headquarters to Atlanta and builds Smilley Plaza in Buckhead. The family buys in Tuxedo Park. Gus writes the Allegiance Clause.
- 1998: Donohue takes a 4% stake in Smilley, now Smilley's largest outside shareholder. Gus signs the deal and then breaks his hand punching a wall.
- 2003: Leonard becomes CEO.
- 2005: Launches Smilley Beauty. 2008: Launches Smilley Home.

2011–2026: The Empire

- 2012: Esther, 19, announces her “IVF twins.” The family closes ranks.
- 2017: Nathaniel launches **RootsKit**, the world's No. 1 consumer DNA test.

- 2020: Leonard becomes Chairman and Gus becomes Chairman Emeritus. Gus names Esther designated heir on Monday, January 6, 2020.
- 2023: Esther becomes President & COO.
- 2025: Market cap reaches \$1.6 trillion. Leonard begins “Project Independence” to end reliance on the Crown License.
- Monday, August 31, 2026, 11:59 PM: The Crown License expires. It's the season-long battle, and it ends in Ep #0166.

Divisions

Division	Leader	What it is
Smilley Consumer & Digital	Nathaniel	Household goods, personal care, RootsKit DNA
Smilley Beauty	Esther (oversight); Desmond (creative)	Cosmetics, hair care, fragrance
Smilley Retail	Esther	Smilley's department stores (1,900 worldwide) and SMLY.com
Smilley Home	Delphine	Furniture, bedding, home fragrance
Smilley Licensed Brands	Esther	Every Donohue-licensed product: the Crown License business
Smilley Wellness	Camille (interim)	Vitamins, fitness, wellness

Share Distribution: Smilley Corporation (NYSE: SMLY)

- **Class A common:** 1 vote per share, publicly traded.
- **Class B common:** 5 votes per share, not traded, 100% owned by Smilley International Holdings.
- Shares outstanding: 8.0 billion at \$200 = \$1.6 trillion.

Holder	Class B (bn)	Class A (bn)	Economic %	Voting %	Value
Smilley International Holdings, Ltd.	2.00	0.56	32.0%	66.0%	\$512B
Donohue Enterprises (strategic stake, 1998)	0.00	0.32	4.0%	2.0%	\$64B
Smilley Family Foundation	0.00	0.08	1.0%	0.5%	\$16B
Directors & officers (excl. SIH)	0.00	0.04	0.5%	0.2%	\$8B
Employee stock plans	0.00	0.20	2.5%	1.2%	\$40B
Index & passive fund managers	0.00	1.60	20.0%	10.0%	\$320B
Active institutional investors	0.00	1.60	20.0%	10.0%	\$320B
Public pension & sovereign funds	0.00	0.80	10.0%	5.0%	\$160B
Retail & other public holders	0.00	0.80	10.0%	5.0%	\$160B
TOTAL	2.00	6.00	100%	100%	\$1,600B

RESULT: The Smilley family owns 32% of the company (\$512 billion) and controls 66.0% of the vote. Donohue Enterprises holds 4.0% of the economics and 2.0% of the votes, which makes it the largest shareholder outside the family.

Share Distribution: Smilley International Holdings, Ltd. (private)

Smilley International Holdings (SIH) is the family holding company, governed by the **Smilley Family Council** under the 1996 Family Charter, including the Allegiance Clause.

Owner	Economic %	Value	Family Council vote
Augustus “Gus” Smilley	30%	\$153.6B	40%
Loretta Smilley	10%	\$51.2B	10%
Leonard Smilley	22%	\$112.6B	25%
Esther Smilley (Designated Heir)	10%	\$51.2B	15%
Nathaniel Smilley	8%	\$41.0B	5%
Camille Smilley-Ward	8%	\$41.0B	5%
Delphine Smilley	8%	\$41.0B	0%

Owner	Economic %	Value	Family Council vote
Desmond Smilley	2%	\$10.2B	0%
Smilley Family Foundation	2%	\$10.2B	0%
TOTAL	100%	\$512B	100%

Rules that drive the drama

- **The Designated Heir** inherits Gus's 30% and his 40% Council vote when he dies. That would make Esther the most powerful Smilley alive.
- **Section 4(c), the Allegiance Clause:** disqualifies any heir tied to the House of Donohue by marriage or through their children. The Council can invoke it by majority vote. Gus plus any one other member is enough.
- **Succession if disqualified:** the title passes to the eldest eligible grandchild. That's Nathaniel.
- **Season 1:** Nathaniel presents the RootsKit evidence at the Family Council (Ep #0163). Gus invokes Section 4(c) (Ep #0164). Esther is suspended unless a DNA test clears her by Labor Day (Ep #0165).